SHORT · PYSPARK SELECT + FILTER

Select and filter rows in PySpark

select picks columns. filter, or where, keeps matching rows. withColumn adds a derived field. None of these change the original DataFrame — they return a new one.

Key points

- Keep validity separate from the business filter (complete qty+price first).
- Actual Free Edition: Books in NORTH or WEST were orders 101 (20.00) and 103 (25.50), sum 45.50.
- Count nulls before cleaning: customer 1, quantity 1, unit_price 1.
- Watch the full Part 1 lesson for the notebook walkthrough.

Tiny example

Shape from the validated Part 1 notebook. Numbers are actual Free Edition results.

```
valid = orders.filter(
  F.col("quantity").isNotNull() &
  F.col("unit_price").isNotNull())
books = (valid
  .where((F.col("category")=="Books") &
         F.col("region").isin("NORTH","WEST"))
  .orderBy("order_id"))
# Actual: 101=20.00, 103=25.50, sum 45.50
```

Misconception check

select and filter do not mutate your DataFrame in place. They describe a new DataFrame. Assign the result if you need to keep it.

Remember

Shape rows with select and filter, and count nulls before you aggregate.

Validated on Databricks Free Edition with serverless compute and Unity Catalog. No paid features are needed for this Short.